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Google Ads Audit Template

A practical, step-by-step checklist to find wasted spend, broken tracking and missed opportunities in any Google Ads account. Tick each check, note what you find, then turn it into a priority action plan.

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Account details

Account name

Customer ID

Audit date

Date range reviewed

Monthly ad spend

Main goal (leads or sales)

Target CPA or ROAS

Audited by

How to use this template

1. Work through the sections in order. Tracking comes first because every other finding depends on it.
2. Mark each check OK, Fix or Critical, and note what you found.
3. Copy the biggest problems to the Top issues page and estimate what each costs.
4. Turn them into the action plan: this week, this month, next quarter.

Status key

OK	Set up correctly
FIX	Worth improving
CRITICAL	Costing money now

What this template covers: 9 sections, 51 checks

1. Conversion tracking
2. Account settings and structure
3. Keywords and search terms
4. Bidding and budgets
5. Ads and assets
6. Landing pages
7. Audiences and targeting
8. Shopping and Performance Max
9. Reporting and measurement

1 Conversion tracking

8 checks

Every other number depends on this. Check it first.

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
1.1	Every primary conversion action is a real lead, call or sale, not a page view, scroll or button click	☐	☐	☐	
1.2	Nothing is counted twice, for example a GA4 import and a Google tag recording the same action	☐	☐	☐	
1.3	Counting is set to One for leads and Every for purchases	☐	☐	☐	
1.4	Purchase values are passed and match your store or CRM figures	☐	☐	☐	
1.5	Enhanced conversions are on and the diagnostics show no errors	☐	☐	☐	
1.6	Offline or CRM conversions are imported where sales close after the click	☐	☐	☐	
1.7	Conversions in Google Ads roughly match your own records for the last 30 days	☐	☐	☐	
1.8	Consent mode is set up for visitors in the UK and EEA	☐	☐	☐	

2 Account settings and structure

7 checks

Settings that quietly send budget to the wrong places.

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
2.1	Brand and non-brand searches run in separate campaigns	☐	☐	☐	
2.2	Campaigns are split by real differences: service, margin, location or goal	☐	☐	☐	
2.3	Location option is set to Presence for businesses that serve people locally	☐	☐	☐	
2.4	Search partners and the Display Network are on only where they perform	☐	☐	☐	
2.5	Auto-applied recommendations are reviewed and switched off where unwanted	☐	☐	☐	
2.6	Ad schedule matches the hours you can answer calls and enquiries	☐	☐	☐	
2.7	Campaign goals match the business goal, such as leads rather than page views	☐	☐	☐	

3 Keywords and search terms

6 checks

Where most wasted spend is found.

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
3.1	Search terms report reviewed for the last 30 to 90 days	☐	☐	☐	
3.2	Search terms with spend and no conversions listed and costed	☐	☐	☐	

3. Keywords and search terms (continued)

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
3.3	Negative keyword lists exist and are applied to the right campaigns	☐	☐	☐	
3.4	No negative keyword blocks a keyword you are bidding on	☐	☐	☐	
3.5	Match types suit the budget, bidding strategy and conversion volume	☐	☐	☐	
3.6	High-spend keywords with low Quality Score identified	☐	☐	☐	

4 Bidding and budgets

5 checks

Making sure the money goes where it earns most.

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
4.1	Bid strategy suits the amount of reliable conversion data	☐	☐	☐	
4.2	Target CPA or ROAS is realistic against recent actual results	☐	☐	☐	
4.3	Campaigns limited by budget identified, profitable ones first	☐	☐	☐	
4.4	Impression share lost to budget and lost to rank reviewed	☐	☐	☐	
4.5	Budget split follows profitability, not habit	☐	☐	☐	

5 Ads and assets

6 checks

What people see before they click.

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
5.1	Every ad group has a responsive search ad with distinct headlines	☐	☐	☐	
5.2	Headlines include the main search terms and a clear offer	☐	☐	☐	
5.3	Pinning is used only where it is genuinely needed	☐	☐	☐	
5.4	Sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets and call assets are added	☐	☐	☐	
5.5	No disapproved or limited ads or assets left unresolved	☐	☐	☐	
5.6	Ad strength reviewed as a guide, not chased as a goal	☐	☐	☐	

6 Landing pages

Where clicks become enquiries, or do not.

5 checks

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
6.1	Each ad group sends traffic to the most relevant page, not the homepage	☐	☐	☐	
6.2	Pages load quickly on a mobile phone	☐	☐	☐	
6.3	The page repeats the promise made in the ad	☐	☐	☐	
6.4	Clear next step: visible phone number, short form, obvious button	☐	☐	☐	
6.5	Form and call tracking still fire after a test submission	☐	☐	☐	

7 Audiences and targeting

Who sees the ads, and where.

4 checks

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
7.1	Remarketing and customer lists added, at least in observation	☐	☐	☐	
7.2	Performance reviewed by device and bids or budgets adjusted	☐	☐	☐	
7.3	User locations report checked for spend outside the service area	☐	☐	☐	
7.4	Demographics reviewed where the policy for your industry allows	☐	☐	☐	

8 Shopping and Performance Max

Skip this section if you do not run them.

6 checks

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
8.1	Merchant Center shows no account issues or disapproved products	☐	☐	☐	
8.2	Product titles, GTINs and images are complete and optimised	☐	☐	☐	
8.3	Brand exclusions applied in Performance Max	☐	☐	☐	
8.4	Performance Max channel and search term reports reviewed	☐	☐	☐	
8.5	Custom labels separate products by margin or best sellers	☐	☐	☐	
8.6	Asset groups have strong images, headlines and, ideally, video	☐	☐	☐	

9 Reporting and measurement

Can you tell what is working?

4 checks

#	CHECK	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	NOTES AND FINDINGS
9.1	Reports show leads or sales and cost per result, not just clicks	☐	☐	☐	
9.2	Brand and non-brand results reported separately	☐	☐	☐	
9.3	Google Ads is linked to GA4 and auto-tagging is on	☐	☐	☐	
9.4	Change history reviewed for recent large changes	☐	☐	☐	

Section score summary

Count the ticks in each section. Any Critical marks go straight onto the Top issues page.

SECTION	OK	FIX	CRITICAL	CHECKS
1. Conversion tracking				8
2. Account settings and structure				7
3. Keywords and search terms				6
4. Bidding and budgets				5
5. Ads and assets				6
6. Landing pages				5
7. Audiences and targeting				4
8. Shopping and Performance Max				6
9. Reporting and measurement				4

Overall verdict

Top issues found

List the biggest problems first. Estimate the monthly cost where you can: wasted spend, or enquiries and sales being missed.

ISSUE	MONTHLY COST	FIX	PRIORITY	OWNER	DUE

Priority guide: Critical = money is being lost now, fix first. High = clear gain within a month. Medium = worth doing once the rest is fixed.

Action plan

Turn the findings into a plan. Fix tracking and the most expensive waste first, then structure, then testing.

This week

Critical fixes: tracking errors, obvious wasted spend, broken pages

This month

Structure, negatives, bidding and budget changes

Next quarter

Testing: ads, landing pages, new campaigns

Want a second pair of eyes?

This template is the same order of checks I use on client accounts. If you would rather have it done for you, there are two ways in.

Free Google Ads audit
A quick first look that lists the issues in your account.

$100 account analysis
Every issue plus the solution for each one, in writing, delivered within 3 days.

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